

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Intended Use: The PediEAT is intended to assess observable symptoms of problematic feeding in children between the ages of 6 months and 7 years old who are being offered some solid foods. The PediEAT is intended to be completed by a caregiver that is familiar with the child's typical eating. This is most often a parent, but may be another primary caregiver.

Disclosure: The PediEAT does not replace a healthcare provider's clinical assessment. The PediEAT is also not intended to provide a diagnosis, but instead may provide the healthcare provider with an objective assessment of the child's eating in order to facilitate diagnosis and treatment decisions.

Referencing Information:

Please give appropriate credit to the authors when presenting, publishing, or otherwise referencing the Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT).

Thoyre, S., Pados, B., Park, J., Estrem, H., Hodges, E., McComish, C., Van Riper, M., and Murdoch, K. (2014). Development and content validation of the Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (Pedi-EAT). *American Journal of Speech-Language Pathology*, 23, 1-14. doi: 10.1044/1058-0360(2013/12-0069)

Thoyre, S., Pados, B., Park, J., Estrem, H., McComish, C., Hodges, E. (2018). The Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool: Factor structure and psychometric properties. *Journal of Pediatric Gastroenterology and Nutrition*, 66(2), 299-305. doi: 10.1097/MPG.0000000000001765 PMID: 28953526

Pados, B.F., Thoyre, S.M., & Park, J. (2018). Age-based norm-reference values for the Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool. *Pediatric Research*, 84(2), 233-239. doi: 10.1038/s41390-018-0067-z

Note: The PediEAT is not in any way associated with the PEDI-EAT-10 by Soyer and colleagues (2017).

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PEDIATRIC EATING ASSESSMENT TOOL (PediEAT)

Directions: We are interested in learning about the eating behaviors of your child. The items below may not apply to every child. When filling this out, think about what is typical for your child at this time.

PHYSIOLOGIC SYMPTOMS

	0	1	2	3	4	5	
My child...	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
1. gets watery eyes when eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
2. gets red color around eyes or face when eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
3. coughs during or after eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
4. sounds gurgly or like they need to cough or clear their throat during or after eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
5. sounds different during or after a meal (for example, voice becomes hoarse, high-pitched, or quiet)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
6. chokes or coughs on water or other thin liquids	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
7. moves head down toward chest when swallowing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
8. has food or liquid come out of nose when eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
9. gets pale or blue color around his/her lips during meals	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
10. breathes faster or harder when eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
11. needs to take a break during the meal to rest or catch their breath	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
12. gets tired from eating and is not able to finish	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
13. sweats/gets clammy during meals	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
14. tilts head back while eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
15. burps more than usual while eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
16. throws up during mealtime	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
17. throws up between meals (from 30 minutes after the last meal until the next meal)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
18. arches back during or after meals	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

	0	1	2	3	4	5	
My child...	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
19. gags when it is time to eat (for example, when they see food or when placed in high chair)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
20. gags with smooth foods like pudding	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
21. gags with textured food like coarse oatmeal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
22. gags, coughs, or vomits when brushing teeth (if your child does not have teeth, select Never. If your child will not allow you to brush his/her teeth, select Always)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
23. gets a bloated tummy after eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
24. turns red in face, may cry with stooling	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
25. has gas	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
26. drools when eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
27. has a hard time eating due to stuffy nose	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Physiologic Symptoms Subscale Score							
If you would like to explain any of your responses, please do so here:							

PROBLEMATIC MEALTIME BEHAVIORS

	0	1	2	3	4	5	
My child...	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
28. avoids eating by playing or talking	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
29. has to be told to start eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
30. has to be reminded to keep eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
31. won't eat at meals, but wants food later	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
32. stops eating after a few bites	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
33. refuses to eat	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
34. shows more stress during meals than during non-meal times (whines, cries, gets angry, tantrums)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
35. likes something one day and not the next	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

	0	1	2	3	4	5	
My child...	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
36. insists on food being offered in a certain way (such as, how food is on the plate or what dish or spoon is used, or where they sit)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
37. insists on being fed by the same person(s)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
38. becomes upset by the smell of food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
39. throws food or pushes food away	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
40. prefers to drink instead of eat	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
41. prefers crunchy foods	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
42. eats better when entertained	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
43. takes more than 30 minutes to eat	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
44. needs mealtime to be calm	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
45. wants the same food for more than two weeks in a row	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Items below are scored according to the numbers at right	5	4	3	2	1	0	
	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	
46. likes to eat	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
47. eats a variety of foods (fruits, vegetables, proteins, etc.)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
48. is willing to stay seated during mealtime	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
49. opens their mouth when food is offered	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
50. is willing to touch food with their hands	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors Subscale Score							
If you would like to explain any of your answers, please do so here:							

SELECTIVE / RESTRICTIVE EATING

	5	4	3	2	1	0	
My child...	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
51. will eat mixed texture foods	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
52. will eat food warmer than room temperature	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
53. is willing to feed self (if younger in age, holds cup, feeds self crackers)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
54. keeps food in mouth when eating (food means non-liquids)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
55. keeps liquids in mouth when drinking	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
56. keeps their tongue inside mouth during eating	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
57. acts hungry before meals	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	5	4	3	2	1	0	
For the following items, if your child is younger than 15 months and is not offered these foods, select Always. If your child is over 15 months and not offered these foods or refuses to eat these foods, select Never.	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
58. will eat foods that need to be chewed	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
59. will eat textured food like coarse oatmeal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
60. will eat frozen food, like ice cream	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
61. chews their food enough	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
62. moves food in their mouth when chewing without help	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Items below are scored according to the numbers at right	0	1	2	3	4	5	
	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
63. sniffs food or objects	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
64. spits food out	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
65. eats too fast	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Selective / Restrictive Eating Subscale Score							
If you would like to explain any of your responses, please do so here:							

ORAL PROCESSING

	0	1	2	3	4	5	
My child...	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
66. stores food in their cheek or roof of mouth	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
67. gets food stuck in their cheek or roof of mouth	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
68. prefers smooth foods like yogurt	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
69. puts too much food in mouth at one time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
70. puts fingers in mouth to move food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
71. prefers strong flavors	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
72. bites down on the spoon or fork and does not release it easily	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
73. grinds teeth when awake (if your child does not have teeth, please select Never.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
74. chews on toys, clothes, or other objects	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Items below are scored according to the numbers at right	0	1	2	3	4	5	
For the following items, if your child is younger than 15 months <u>and</u> is not offered chewable foods, select Never. If your child is over 15 months and not offered these foods or refuses to eat these foods, select Always.	Never	Almost Never	Sometimes	Often	Almost Always	Always	Score
75. has to be reminded to chew food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
76. sucks on food to soften or moisten it, rather than chewing it	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
77. chews food but doesn't swallow it	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
78. chews a bite of food for a long time (~30 seconds or longer)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Oral Processing Subscale Score							
If you would like to explain any of your responses, please do so here:							

PEDIATRIC EATING ASSESSMENT TOOL (PediEAT)

SCORING INSTRUCTIONS

1. Scores are assigned to PediEAT items with lower scores indicating fewer symptoms and higher scores indicating more symptoms of problematic feeding. There are numbers above the items indicating the score that each response would receive. Note that the scores may change between the subscales. For example, the Physiologic Symptoms subscale is scored with Never = 0 and Always = 5, while the Selective / Restrictive Eating subscale is scored with Never = 5 and Always = 0. Also note that within the Problematic Mealtime Behaviors subscale and the Selective / Restrictive Eating subscale, there are a subset of items at the bottom that are scored differently than the other items in that subscale. You may use the right column on the PediEAT to record the score for each item.
2. There are some items that may not apply to a child based on the child's age. For example, there are specific instructions to parents above the items pertaining to chewing. If a child is less than 15 months old and not being offered chewable foods, they are to score it as not problematic. If a child is older than 15 months and not yet being offered chewable foods or refuses to eat the types of foods specified, the parent should answer in a way that indicates that is problematic.
3. Add the scores for each item within each subscale. A box is provided at the end of each subscale to record the total score for that subscale. Transfer each subscale score to the table below. Calculate the total score by adding up all of the subscale scores.
4. Use the age-specific reference values on the subsequent pages to determine the level of concern associated with the score the child received. Please note that corrected age should be used when choosing the age-specific reference values if the child is less than 2 years old and he/she was born at less than 37 weeks post-menstrual age (i.e., the child was born more than 3 weeks before their due date).

	Score	Level of Concern (circle)		
Physiologic Symptoms		No Concern	Concern	High Concern
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors		No Concern	Concern	High Concern
Selective / Restrictive Eating		No Concern	Concern	High Concern
Oral Processing		No Concern	Concern	High Concern
Total Score		No Concern	Concern	High Concern

Notes:

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Infants 6 - 9 months old

The following reference values are for infants between 6 months 0 days and 9 months 0 days old. If the child was born prior to 37 weeks post-menstrual age, please use the child's corrected age when determining which reference values to use.

	< 90th %	90th - 95th %	> 95th %
	No Concern	Concern	High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 27	27 - 31	32 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 30	30 - 36	37 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 26	26 - 27	28 - 75
Oral Processing	< 37	37 - 42	43 - 65
Total Score	< 101	101 - 116	117 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Infants 9 - 12 months old

The following reference values are for infants between 9 months 1 day and 12 months 0 days old. If the child was born prior to 37 weeks post-menstrual age, please use the child's corrected age when determining which reference values to use.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 24	24 - 31	32 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 32	32 - 38	39 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 27	27 - 31	32 - 75
Oral Processing	< 32	32 - 37	38 - 65
Total Score	< 102	102 - 124	125 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 12 - 15 months old

The following reference values are for children between 12 months 1 day and 15 months 0 days old. If the child was born prior to 37 weeks post-menstrual age, please use the child's corrected age when determining which reference values to use.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 29	29 - 34	35 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 38	38 - 46	47 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 28	28 - 31	32 - 75
Oral Processing	< 31	31 - 35	36 - 65
Total Score	< 107	107 - 125	126 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 15 - 18 months old

The following reference values are for children between 15 months 1 day and 18 months 0 days old. If the child was born prior to 37 weeks post-menstrual age, please use the child's corrected age when determining which reference values to use.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 17	17 - 20	21 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 38	38 - 44	45 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 26	26 - 28	29 - 75
Oral Processing	< 29	29 - 32	33 - 65
Total Score	< 98	98 - 110	111 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 18 - 24 months old

The following reference values are for children between 18 months 1 day and 24 months 0 days old. If the child was born prior to 37 weeks post-menstrual age, please use the child's corrected age when determining which reference values to use.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 16	16 - 22	23 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 43	43 - 48	49 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 22	22 - 27	28 - 75
Oral Processing	< 24	24 - 30	31 - 65
Total Score	< 97	97 - 107	108 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 2 - 2.5 years old

The following reference values are for children between 2 years 1 day and 2.5 years 0 days old. If the child was born prior to 37 weeks post-menstrual age, please use the child's corrected age when determining which reference values to use.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 18	18 - 21	22 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 47	47 - 48	49 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 23	23 - 28	29 - 75
Oral Processing	< 27	27 - 33	34 - 65
Total Score	< 106	106 - 120	121 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 2.5 - 3 years old

The following reference values are for children between 2.5 years 1 day and 3 years 0 days old.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 15	15 - 22	23 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 54	54 - 60	61 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 21	21 - 25	26 - 75
Oral Processing	< 26	26 - 29	30 - 65
Total Score	< 109	109 - 119	120 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 3 - 4 years old

The following reference values are for children between 3 years 1 day and 4 years 0 days old.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 16	16 - 19	20 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 51	51 - 55	56 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 20	20 - 22	23 - 75
Oral Processing	< 27	27 - 29	30 - 65
Total Score	< 106	106 - 112	113 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 4 - 5 years old

The following reference values are for children between 4 years 1 day and 5 years 0 days old.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 16	16 - 19	20 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 51	51 - 57	58 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 19	19 - 21	22 - 75
Oral Processing	< 24	24 - 27	28 - 65
Total Score	< 102	102 - 114	115 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 5 - 6 years old

The following reference values are for children between 5 years 1 day and 6 years 0 days old.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 14	14 - 19	20 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 51	51 - 54	55 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 16	16 - 22	23 - 75
Oral Processing	< 22	22 - 26	27 - 65
Total Score	< 96	96 - 109	110 - 390

Pediatric Eating Assessment Tool (PediEAT)

Reference Values for Children 6 - 7 years old

The following reference values are for children between 6 years 1 day and 7 years 0 days old.

	< 90th % No Concern	90th - 95th % Concern	> 95th % High Concern
Physiologic Symptoms	< 14	14 - 18	19 - 135
Problematic Mealtime Behaviors	< 42	42 - 47	48 - 115
Selective / Restrictive Eating	< 19	19 - 20	21 - 75
Oral Processing	< 23	23 - 27	28 - 65
Total Score	< 82	82 - 99	100 - 390